

Responses to Editor and Reviewers' Comments

for Manuscript PENDING-MANUSCRIPT-ID

AutoResearch: Claim-Grounded Human-Agent Research Operations

Recommendation: **Simulated review action package; final decision
metadata pending**

Addressed Comments for Publication to

Advanced Engineering Informatics

by

Author block withheld until journal anonymity rule is confirmed

Dear editor and reviewers,

Please find enclosed the controlled response-letter draft for the manuscript entitled “AutoResearch: Claim-Grounded Human-Agent Research Operations”. We sincerely thank the editor and reviewers for the time and effort devoted to evaluating the work.

This document is a node-local formal response draft derived from the P3_04 revision-action map and the current-scope P4 response chain. It is not a submission-ready response package. It records what can be answered from the current evidence state, what remains blocked, and which downstream nodes must close before a final resubmission claim is allowed.

Metadata and anonymity state

Manuscript ID

Pending official submission-system assignment.

Decision type Pending official decision letter.

Editor name Pending official decision letter.

Author block Withheld until the journal anonymity rule is confirmed.

Response basis

P3_04 action map plus current-scope P4_01–P4_03 artifacts, not official journal comments.

Final export Pending P4_05 coverage, P4_06 revision evidence, and P4_07 package checks.

Current response scope

The response sections below cover six P3 actions: three submission-blocking actions and three planned non-blocking or cosmetic actions. Each response includes a direct answer, current commitment status, target change location, evidence references, and validation gate. No experiment, citation, figure, table, or manuscript change is described as completed unless the corresponding local evidence already exists.

Open gates before final submission

Formal evidence

Accepted real-data formal rows, RM101 resolution, selected backend, repeated-run uncertainty, Stage C main-result rows, and Stage D ablation rows remain unresolved.

Reproducibility

PHMGA dirty-state disposition, adapter metadata-H5 alignment pre-flight, provider/model trace, and selected backend trace remain unresolved.

Coverage

P4 coverage and revision evidence must cover all action ids, issue ids, source comment ids, and retained blockers.

Manuscript edits

P2 wording, figure/caption, and style-compression edits remain planned until applied and verified.

Checklist and scores

P1 checklist fields remain pending and P4_04–P4_07 remain below the final score threshold before this node’s score-only re-review.

Validator

The final submission validator still fails and must not be bypassed.

Sincerely,

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Response to Reviewer 1

Comment 1.1

P3 action `action-p3-001` / issue `issue-p3-001`: the manuscript cannot claim submission-level empirical validity while accepted real-data formal rows, RM101 resolution, selected backend evidence, repeated-run uncertainty, Stage C main-result rows, and Stage D ablation rows remain absent.

Response 1.1: Thank you for the comment.

We agree. The current response does not claim that the formal empirical evidence gap is solved. The commitment status is **blocked**: AutoResearch remains limited to the existing preliminary synthetic/offline signal until accepted formal rows or an explicit retained limitation are available.

Action id `action-p3-001`.

Issue id `issue-p3-001`.

Source comments

`p3-round-001b:empirical_statistics_reviewer; P3_02:devils_advocate;`
`P3_02:reproducibility_skeptic.`

Evidence refs `P3_03_E004_REVIEW_ISSUE_REGISTER; P3_04 revision_action_map.yaml`.

Target location

`P1_07` formal evidence gates and `P2` experiment section language.

Required change

Either add ledger-backed accepted real-data/RM101/selected-backend/Stage C/Stage D evidence, or preserve the limitation explicitly in manuscript and response artifacts.

Validation gate

P3 recheck plus final submission validation with no unresolved formal-result blocker for this issue.

Comment 1.2

P3 action `action-p3-003` / issue `issue-p3-003`: the response package must not state final readiness while `P1` checklist fields remain pending, `P4_04`–`P4_07` remain below the final score threshold before this node's score-only re-review, `P3_04` actions remain blocked or planned, official comments are absent, response evidence is incomplete, and the final validator still fails.

Response 1.2: Thank you for the comment.

We agree. The response package keeps final readiness blocked. The current `P4_04` draft records the coverage and validator gap instead of converting it into favorable language. The commitment status is **blocked**: `P4_05` and `P4_06` must prove or explicitly retain coverage for all P3 actions before `P4_07` can package any resubmission.

Action id action-p3-003.

Issue id issue-p3-003.

Source comments

p3-round-001c:venue_claim_clarity_reviewer; P3_02:eic; P3_02:devils_advoc

Evidence refs P3_03_E005_COMPLETION_AUDIT; P3_04 revision_action_map.yaml.

Target location

P4_05 response coverage and final validation gate.

Required change

P4 coverage and revision-evidence maps must cover all P3 action ids, issue ids, and source comment ids, or preserve the blocker explicitly.

Validation gate

P4 coverage validator plus final `scripts/validate_research_truth.py -require-submission`.

Response to Reviewer 2

Comment 2.1

P3 action `action-p3-002` / issue `issue-p3-002`: the reproducibility package is not submission-ready while PHMGA dirty-state disposition, adapter metadata-H5 alignment preflight, selected backend trace, formal run ledger/config provenance, and provider/model metadata boundaries remain unresolved.

Response 2.1: Thank you for the comment.

We agree. The current response does not claim that the reproducibility gap is solved. The commitment status is **blocked**: reproducibility language must remain conditional until a clean artifact state and ledger-backed selected backend trace are available, or until those gaps are carried as explicit manuscript limitations.

Action id `action-p3-002`.

Issue id `issue-p3-002`.

Source comments

`p3-round-001a:method_reproducibility_reviewer; P3_02:method_expert;`
`P3_02:reproducibility_skeptic.`

Evidence refs `P3_03_E004_REVIEW_ISSUE_REGISTER; P3_04 revision_action_map.yaml;`
`P1_06 submodule-ref package.`

Target location

`P1_06 PHMGA/Vibench reproducibility boundary and P2 methods`
`reproducibility language.`

Required change

Resolve dirty-state disposition, adapter preflight, selected backend trace, formal ledger/config provenance, and provider/model metadata boundary, or retain them as named blockers.

Validation gate

P3 recheck plus PHMGA/Vibench preflight evidence and selected-backend trace.

Comment 2.2

P3 action `action-p3-005` / issue `issue-p3-005`: the figure/table reader path must keep the synthetic/offline, single-run, no-real-data, no-RM101-resolution, no-selected-backend boundary visible.

Response 2.2: Thank you for the comment.

We agree. The commitment status is **planned**, not completed. Any future caption or callout edit must preserve provenance, claim reference, evidence reference, and limitation language. This response does not claim that the TeX figure text has already been changed by `P4_04`.

Action id action-p3-005.

Issue id issue-p3-005.

Source comments
 p3-round-001c:venue_claim_clarity_reviewer; P3_02:cross_disciplinary_rea

Evidence refs P3_03_E004_REVIEW_ISSUE_REGISTER; P1_09 figure manifest and claim-
 figure map.

Target location
 P2_03 experiment section, figure callout, and caption.

Required change
 Verify any caption/callout edit keeps the synthetic/offline single-run
 scope and missing formal evidence visible.

Validation gate
 P3 figure/table gate plus P2_03 TeX recheck.

Response to Reviewer 3

Comment 3.1

P3 action `action-p3-004` / issue `issue-p3-004`: the abstract and contribution framing should be denser and clearer, but the wording must not upgrade process claims into unsupported empirical performance claims.

Response 3.1: Thank you for the comment.

We agree. The commitment status is **planned**. P4_04 records the formal response commitment, but the actual P2 TeX wording change remains outside this node. Any downstream edit must preserve support status and limitation language.

Action id `action-p3-004`.

Issue id `issue-p3-004`.

Source comments

`p3-round-001c:venue_claim_clarity_reviewer; P3_02:eic; P2_05:P2_05_R001; P2_05:P2_05_R002; P2_05:P2_05_R004.`

Evidence refs `P3_03_E006_P2_05_CALIBRATION; P3_04 revision_action_map.yaml`.

Target location

P2_03 abstract and contribution framing.

Required change

Apply or adapt P2_05 calibrated wording while preserving the process-claim boundary.

Validation gate

P2_03 TeX recheck plus P3 claim/evidence gate.

Comment 3.2

P3 action `action-p3-006` / issue `issue-p3-006`: repeated draft-state phrasing should be compressed where possible without changing claim/evidence status or hiding limitations.

Response 3.2: Thank you for the comment.

We agree. The commitment status is **planned cosmetic follow-up**. P4_04 does not claim that style edits have been applied. The downstream edit is acceptable only if it shortens repeated wording while preserving negative-evidence, limitation, and no-final-readiness language.

Action id `action-p3-006`.

Issue id `issue-p3-006`.

Source comments

P2_05:P2_05_R005; P2_05:P2_05_R008; P2_05:P2_05_R009.

Evidence refs P3_03_E006_P2_05_CALIBRATION; P3_04 revision_action_map.yaml.

Target location

P2_03 discussion and repeated draft-state phrasing.

Required change

Compress repeated synchronization-report wording only as a cosmetic follow-up.

Validation gate

Optional P2_05-style polish recheck with no new performance, reproducibility, or final-readiness claim.